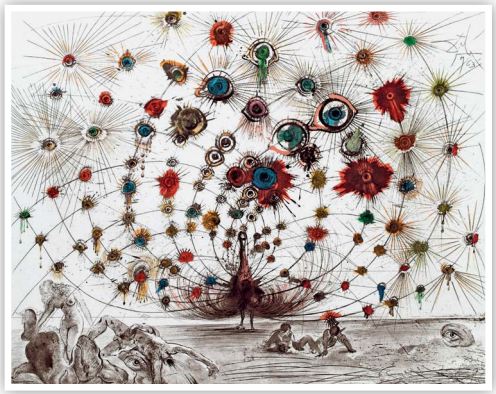
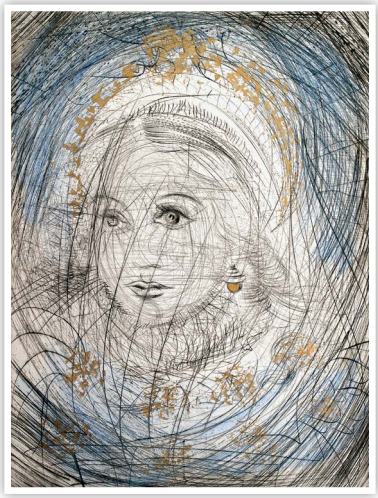


THE RAPTURE (From left) 'Individual-Argus in Color' (drypoint etching); and 'Faust-Portrait of Marguerite' (etching on japon)



DALÍ IN DELHI

ART

The **greatest surrealist artist** of the 20th century comes to India in a major exhibition

Dali Comes To India is on in Delhi at the Visual Art Gallery, India Habitat Centre (Feb. 7-12), and then at Massarrat by Bruno Art Group, GK-2, (Feb. 15-Mar. 16)

A landmark exhibition is bringing over 200 works by Salvador Dali to Delhi for the first time. Drawn from the prestigious Pierre Argillet Collection, the works include etchings, watercolours, tapestries and other surrealist interpretations. "Dalí's masterpieces challenge the very boundaries of reality, offering a journey into realms where the subconscious unfolds and imagination knows no bounds. Few can match Dalí's ability in showing how humanity can sometimes be found even within the phenomena of war, confusion and pain," says exhibition host Motti Abramovitz, owner and CEO, Bruno Art Group.

The exhibition consists of selected original etchings from the early 1960s, like the illustrations of Greek mythology and also the Hippies series inspired by the hippie movement. Other pieces on display include 'Study for the Demons', a large ink drawing of dancing characters that Dalí sketched for the illustrations of Mao Zedong Poems in 1968 as well as two rare Aubusson tapestries, 'Woman with Garter' and 'Women in the Waves'.

Between 1960 and 1964, Dalí did 16 copper plates on illustrated Greek mythology. "He was returning from the US where he had lived for eight years, and wanted to experiment with the throw of acid on matrix plates," explains Christine Argillet, the exhibition's curator. In 'The Elephants', the animals in Dalí's imagery are curiously shown with frail long legs. "We find several depictions of elephants in Dalí's paintings. In a sort of hypnosis, they inflict sleep on the characters around them... the elephants have a sharp eye and their faces looks much like Dalí himself," says Argillet.

Dalí's ground-breaking contributions to surrealism continue to resonate with contemporary issues such as identity and mental health. "His body of work is part of western tradition, strongly influenced by the Italian Renaissance, but also by the freedom of the Dada and Surrealist movements as well as the research on the depths of the unconscious mind via the expression of dreams. Dalí's extraordinary imagination obliges the viewer to reconsider what he or she takes for granted," concludes Argillet. ■

–Neha Kirpal

Cubism, pioneered by greats like Pablo Picasso and Georges Braque in the early 20th century, challenged conventional perspectives through its exploration of abstraction and multiple perspectives. Initially, Cubist art was rejected by many for its confusing methodology. Eventually, it influenced the trajectory of artistic expression across the world, including India–evolving into a new visual language to represent reality. A new exhibition at DAG Delhi, *Deconstructed Realms: India's Tryst with Cubism*, offers a window into this brief encounter between India and Cubism.

"As a result of early encounters between European and Indian artist-patrons, western pedagogy changed art practices in India. This evolution steered the creation of new, dynamic forms of art such as the Company School, Early Bengal oil paintings and even the Kalighat Pats," says Ashish Anand, CEO and managing director, DAG.

The show, scheduled from February 8 to April 5, attempts to deconstruct the journey of the stylistic art form through four sections. While 'The Cubist Awakening' focuses on cross-cultural exchange and fragmented forms from the 1920s